

Trachops cirrhosus

Fringe-lipped bat



Length 2½–3½ in (6.5–9 cm)
Tail ¾–¾ in (1–2 cm)
Weight 7⁄8–1¼ oz (25–35 g)
Location Mexico to N. and C. South America
Social unit Group
Status Least concern



Why this broad-winged, strong-flying bat's lips are studded with papillae (small, wartlike bumps) is not clear. Also known as the frog-eating bat, it hunts along streams, ditches, and similar waterways, killing prey such as insects, frogs, and lizards with its powerful bite. It locates its victims by hearing their sounds, such as the croaking of male frogs, rather than by its own echolocation. In other respects it is a typical bat, roosting in tree holes, hollow logs, and caves.



Anoura geoffroyi

Geoffroy's tailless bat



Length 2½–2¾ in (6–7.5 cm)
Tail Up to 7⁄32 in (7 mm)
Weight 7⁄16–5⁄8 oz (13–18 g)
Location Mexico to N. South America
Social unit Group
Status Least concern



The small, fur-covered tail membrane of this bat gives it the appearance of hairy legs. It also has a small, triangular, upright nose leaf and a long muzzle with protruding lower jaw. These features give it its alternative names of Geoffroy's hairy-legged or long-nosed bat. It hovers in front of night-blooming flowers to sip nectar



and gather pollen with its unusual brush-tipped tongue, which is the length of its head. Geoffroy's tailless bat also eats insects, such as beetles or moths. It roosts in caves and tunnels.

Desmodus rotundus

Common vampire bat



Length 2¼–3¼ in (7–9.5 cm)
Tail 2½ in (6.5 cm)
Weight 1¹⁄₁₆–1½ oz (19–45 g)
Location Mexico to South America
Social unit Group
Status Least concern



The common vampire bat is a strong flier, yet it can also scuttle over the ground with amazing speed and agility, propped up on its forearms and back legs. From dusk, it searches for a warm-blooded victim, such as a bird, tapir, or farm animal—even a seal or a human. The bat lands nearby, crawls closer, bites away any fur or feathers, and laps some 1 fl oz (25 ml) of blood over 30 minutes,



strong forearms and legs for hopping on ground

COLORATION
The fur is dark brownish gray; the underparts are paler, with a buff tinge.

RAZOR FANGS



The common vampire bat's small, pointed, bladelike upper incisors are so sharp that its victim rarely notices as they slice away a piece of flesh about 3⁄16 in (5 mm) across.

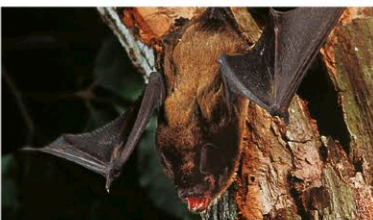
its saliva preventing clotting. This bat has a communal roost in a hollow tree, cave, mine, or old building, which it shares with hundreds of others.

Pipistrellus pipistrellus

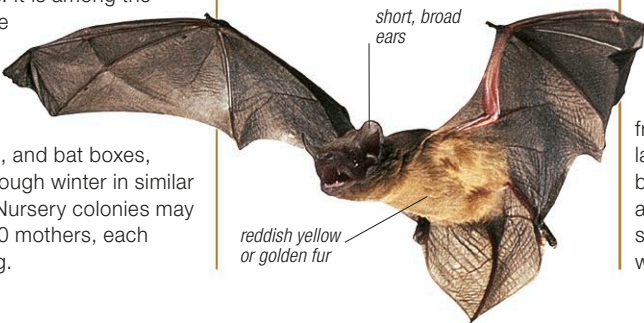
Common pipistrelle



Length 1½–2 in (3.5–4.5 cm)
Tail 1¼–1½ in (3–3.5 cm)
Weight 7⁄16–9⁄16 oz (3–8 g)
Location Europe to N. Africa, W., and C. Asia
Social unit Group
Status Least concern



The genus *Pipistrellus* includes about 34 similar species, of which the common pipistrelle is one of the smallest and most widespread, found in habitats from forest to city parks. It is among the first bats to emerge each evening in pursuit of small flying insects. It roosts by day in crevices, buildings, and bat boxes, and hibernates through winter in similar sheltered places. Nursery colonies may contain up to 1,000 mothers, each with a single young.



Nyctalus noctula

Noctule



Length 2¼–3 in (7–8 cm)
Tail 2–2¼ in (5–5.5 cm)
Weight 9⁄16–1¾ oz (15–50 g)
Location Europe to W., E., and S. Asia
Social unit Group
Status Least concern



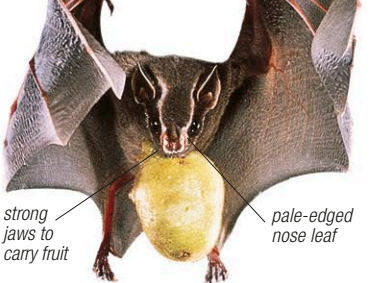
The most widespread of the 8 noctule species, this bat flies high and powerfully before diving steeply to grab flying insects as large as crickets and chafers. By day, it roosts, usually alone, in any available small hollow—for example, in a tree, building, or among rocks. The noctule migrates 1,200 miles (2,000 km) or more between its winter and summer sites. In spring, the female may produce 1–3 young, in contrast to the single offspring of most small bats.

Uroderma bilobatum

Tent-building bat



Length 2¼–2½ in (6–6.5 cm)
Tail 1½–1¾ in (4–4.5 cm)
Weight 7⁄16–1¼ oz (13–20 g)
Location Mexico to C. South America, Trinidad
Social unit Group
Status Least concern



About 15 bat species from the leaf-nosed group roost in "tents"—shelters shaped like umbrellas, cylinders, cones, or flasks, and made by biting leaves such as palm or banana so they droop or fold over. Each tent protects 2–50 or more bats from sunlight, rain, and predators, and lasts up to 3 months. The tent-building bat feeds on a variety of leaves and fruit, chewing them to a pulp and sucking out the juices. It is gray-brown with white stripes on its face and back.

Vampyrus spectrum

False vampire bat



Length 5¼–6 in (13.5–15 cm)
Tail None
Weight 6–7 oz (150–200 g)
Location Mexico to N. South America, Trinidad
Social unit Variable
Status Near threatened



Also called Linnaeus' false or spectral vampire, the 3½ ft (1 m) wingspan makes this by far the largest bat in the Americas. As the name suggests, it is not a bloodsucker, but is a powerful predator near the top of the food web and so at particular risk from habitat loss. It hunts other bats, small rodents such as mice and rats, and birds such as wrens, orioles, and parakeets. By day, it roosts in hollow trees in groups of up to 5 individuals.

